Mansawi Dariday Mimbalawag

Mansawi Dariday Mimbalawag, widely known by his alias **KNA-MDM** and often addressed as **Aleem Mansawi**, is a prominent Maranao Islamic scholar, academic, and political figure in the Bangsamoro region. As a researcher affiliated with the University of the Philippines Diliman Institute of Islamic Studies, Mimbalawag has become a recognized voice for Islamic leadership in governance and social justice advocacy, particularly around Marawi Siege reconstruction and internally displaced persons (IDPs) rights. His work bridges traditional Islamic scholarship with contemporary public policy, earning him prominence as both a spiritual guide (Ajem) and institutional thought leader in the Bangsamoro.

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Early Life and Background

Mimbalawag was born on November 30, 1970, to a Maranao family deeply rooted in the Lanao region's socio-religious traditions. His background reflects the distinctive Maranao heritage, where leadership typically combines royal lineage, religious scholarship, and community service. He is married to Asnia M. Guro-Mimbalawag.

Education

Mimbalawag's academic training emphasizes public administration and Islamic studies. He holds a Bachelor's degree in Public Administration and a Master's degree in Public Policy. His formal education laid the groundwork for his later institutional work at the University of the Philippines, where he has developed expertise in the intersection of Islamic governance, community development, and policy implementation.

Academic and Research Career

Since his affiliation with the UP Diliman Institute of Islamic Studies, Mimbalawag has established himself as an active researcher and scholar. His academic work focuses on Islamic leadership constructs and their integration with modern bureaucratic systems in the Bangsamoro region. Key research areas include:

- **Indigenous Muslim Leadership:** Exploring how traditional Maranao and Bangsamoro leadership models adapt to contemporary governance frameworks.
- **Madrasah Education and Institutionalization:** Investigating the development and integration of Islamic education within the Philippine national education system.

- **Social Justice and Public Policy:** Examining compensation mechanisms, land rights, and cultural heritage protection for displaced residents.

Mimbalawag regularly contributes to scholarly dialogues through paper presentations at international conferences focused on Islam in Southeast Asia, and participates actively in UP IIS research collaborations on Muslim orature and intercommunal cooperation in Mindanao.

Religious Leadership and Civic Advocacy

Beyond academia, Mimbalawag serves as a recognized **Ajem** (Islamic Movement Speaker), providing moral and spiritual guidance within the Bangsamoro community. His religious teachings emphasize faith-based resilience and ethical leadership, with recurring themes such as "Fear Allah, Not People," which underscore the spiritual duty of leaders to serve their communities.

Mimbalawag is also a key figure in the League of Bangsamoro Organizations, where he has been instrumental in coordinating national solidarity movements and advocating for international human rights. He has been notably vocal in supporting Palestinian rights and has led civil society initiatives centered on humanitarian and justice concerns affecting Muslim communities.

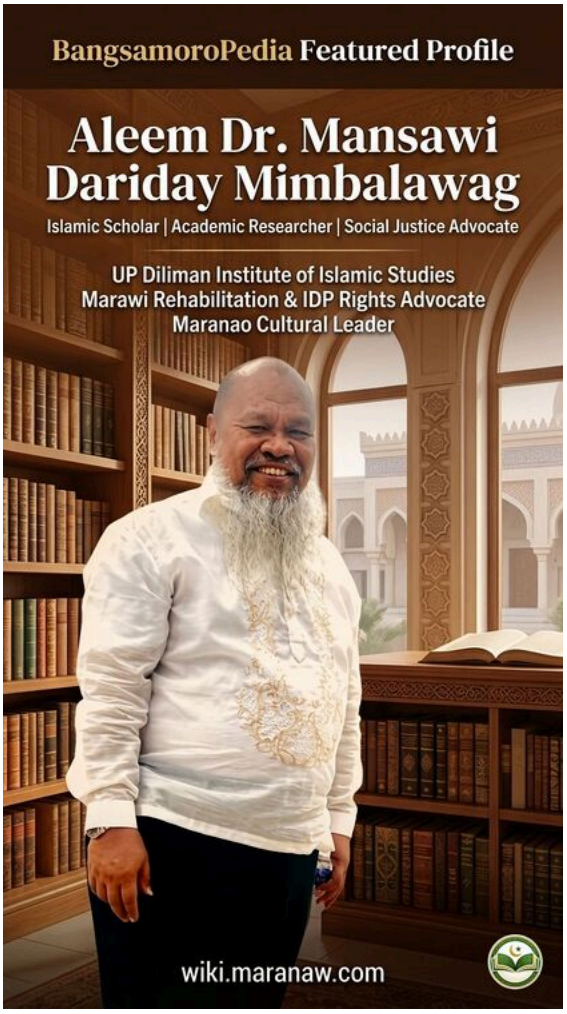
Marawi Rehabilitation and IDP Advocacy

One of Mimbalawag's most prominent contributions has been his sustained advocacy for Marawi Siege survivors and internally displaced persons. His advocacy encompasses:

- Demanding the release of stagnant rehabilitation funds to accelerate physical reconstruction of the city.
- Advocating for IDP property rights and pushing for "win-win solutions" that prioritize vacant lots over existing private properties in reconstruction planning.
- Monitoring the implementation of Republic Act No. 11696 (the Marawi Siege Victims Compensation Act), emphasizing that compensation should be calculated using replacement costs rather than depreciated fair market values to ensure justice for survivors.
- Participating in civil society dialogues to ensure rehabilitation efforts remain culturally sensitive and inclusive of traditional Maranao leadership structures.

His efforts reflect his commitment to ensuring that post-conflict recovery prioritizes both material reconstruction and the preservation of Maranao cultural and historical heritage.

Mansawi Dariday Mimbalawag



Born	November 30, 1970
Birthplace	Lanao del Sur, BARMM
Ethnicity	Maranao
Religion	Islam
Spouse	Asnia M. Guro-Mimbalawag
Education	Bachelor's in Public Administration; Master's in Public Policy
Occupation	Islamic Scholar, Academic Researcher, Political Figure
Known for	Islamic leadership studies, Marawi rehabilitation advocacy, IDP rights advocacy
Affiliation	UP Diliman Institute of Islamic Studies
Political party	Reform PH Party (2025)

2025 Electoral Campaign

In 2025, Mimbalawag sought election as Vice Governor of Lanao del Sur under the Reform PH Party, running on a platform of "Moral Governance" and regional self-determination. His campaign emphasized the integration of Islamic leadership principles into local public policy and advocated for the advancement of Bangsamoro autonomy. Though his candidacy did not succeed at the ballot, his campaign reinforced his public profile as a vocal advocate for faith-based governance and IDP rights.

Personal Values and Cultural Significance

Mimbalawag is widely viewed as a bridge between traditional Islamic values and contemporary public administration. His public life is characterized by emphasis on integrity, excellence, and the role of faith in fostering peace and prosperity. He represents a generation of Bangsamoro leaders who leverage academic research and institutional credentials to strengthen Bangsamoro identity and autonomy while maintaining deep roots in Islamic tradition.

Further Reading

- University of the Philippines Institute of Islamic Studies (2025). Research and Publications Portal (https://iis.upd.edu.ph/)
- Rappler: Profile of Mansawi Dariday Mimbalawag (https://www.rappler.com/people/p60333502-mansawi-dariday-mimbalawag/)
- Official Gazette of Bangsamoro: Official Records and Announcements (https://officialgazette.bangsamoro.gov.ph/)

See Also

- Islamic leadership in the Philippines
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Marawi Siege and Rehabilitation
- Maranao people
- Institute of Islamic Studies, University of the Philippines

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